A Survey on Dynamic Video-Style Generation Techniques for World-Famous Paintings: From Oil and Ink Style Transfer to Painting Animation

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Abstract

World-famous paintings, ranging from Western oil masterpieces of Van Gogh and Rembrandt to Eastern ink wash landscapes, constitute a unique reservoir of human cultural heritage. In recent years, the rapid development of deep generative models has opened a new direction: *dynamic video-style generation for famous paintings*, which aims to bring static artworks to life through artistic style transfer, image-to-video synthesis, and portrait/painting animation. This survey provides a structured overview of this emerging area along four axes: (i) foundations of artistic style transfer; (ii) video style transfer with temporal consistency; (iii) diffusion-based image and video stylization; and (iv) painting synthesis, stroke rendering, and "talking painting" animation. We focus on representative works published in top-tier venues including CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, and IJCAI, and discuss open challenges such as content leakage, long-video coherence, and art-specific aesthetic preservation. Building on the survey, we further propose four research ideas that combine open-source local video diffusion backbones (LTX-Video, Wan2.1/2.2) with human-in-the-loop artistic guidance, multi-granular control over color and stroke distributions, and innovations drawn from classical art-creation theory.

1 Introduction

Famous paintings encode not only colors and brushstrokes but also the cultural and emotional intent of their creators. Bringing such static artworks to life—in the form of short videos—has become a compelling research and educational objective, enabling museum experiences, AI-driven storytelling, and creative content production. Recent "living portrait" demonstrations, in which the *Mona Lisa* or Rembrandt self-portraits are animated from a single image, illustrate the public appeal of this direction Zakharov *et al.* [2019]; Guo *et al.* [2024].

Three technological threads have converged to make famous-painting video generation possible: **(1) artistic style transfer**, which maps the visual appearance of a reference painting onto a target image or video; **(2) image-to-video (I2V) and video-to-video (V2V) generation**, which animate static content with temporally coherent motion; and **(3) painting synthesis and stroke rendering**, which emulate the physical creation process of paintings, including brushstroke dynamics. This survey organizes representative works along these axes, with an emphasis on results published at CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, and IJCAI over the past decade.

2 Foundations of Artistic Style Transfer

2.1 Optimization-Based and Feed-Forward Methods

The seminal work of Gatys *et al.* [2016] demonstrated that the style of an artwork can be separated from its content using Gram-matrix statistics of deep CNN features, giving rise to Neural Style Transfer (NST). Johnson *et al.* [2016] subsequently proposed a feed-forward network trained with perceptual losses, enabling real-time stylization. To support arbitrary styles at inference time, Huang and Belongie [2017] introduced Adaptive Instance Normalization (AdaIN), which aligns the channel-wise mean and variance of content features to those of style features. Park and Lee [2019] further proposed style-attentional networks (SANet) to attend to relevant style patches.

2.2 Transformer-Based Arbitrary Style Transfer

Vision transformers have enabled long-range style modeling. Deng *et al.* [2022] proposed StyTr^2, which uses a transformer encoder–decoder to transfer style across arbitrary contents, alleviating the loss of detail common to AdaIN-based methods. These foundations are the bedrock upon which painting-specific and video-specific methods are built.

3 Video Style Transfer and Temporal Consistency

A naive application of image style transfer frame-by-frame produces severe flicker. Addressing this, Ruder *et al.* [2016] introduced a temporal loss based on optical flow to constrain consecutive frames, while Chen *et al.* [2017] proposed an online recurrent framework that propagates stylized features across frames. Huang *et al.* [2017] presented a real-time feed-forward model for video stylization.

3.1 Regularization-Based Approaches

Wang *et al.* [2020b] reinterpreted temporal consistency as a compound regularization problem and designed a zero-shot video style transfer framework, published at AAAI 2020. Deng *et al.* [2021] proposed multi-channel correlation for arbitrary video style transfer (AAAI 2021), enabling a single network to handle diverse artistic references without retraining. Gao *et al.* [2018] introduced ReCoNet, optimizing temporal stability through flow-based warping losses.

3.2 Diffusion-Based Video Stylization

The diffusion era has dramatically reshaped video stylization. Ceylan *et al.* [2023] and Chai *et al.* [2023] (ICCV 2023) showed that image diffusion models can be extended to video editing by self-attention injection and consistency-aware sampling. Geyer *et al.* [2024] enforced feature consistency across frames through token-level propagation. More recently, Ye *et al.* [2025] proposed StyleMaster (CVPR 2025), which combines prompt-patch similarity filtering, contrastive style learning, and a lightweight motion adapter to bridge the image-to-video gap. EchoStyle Li *et al.* [2026] constructs a large-scale stylization dataset of 20k video pairs via reverse synthesis and achieves performance comparable to commercial closed-source solutions.

4 Diffusion Models for Image and Video Generation

4.1 Foundations

Latent Diffusion Models (LDM) Rombach *et al.* [2022] established the dominant paradigm for high-resolution text-to-image synthesis. Controllability was extended by ControlNet Zhang *et al.* [2023a], while subject personalization was enabled by DreamBooth Ruiz *et al.* [2023] and Textual Inversion Gal *et al.* [2023], with LoRA Hu *et al.* [2022] providing efficient fine-tuning. These tools form the practical foundation for painting-style generation pipelines that combine pretrained diffusion backbones with style LoRAs and ControlNet conditioning.

4.2 Inversion-Based Style Transfer

Zhang *et al.* [2023b] proposed InST (CVPR 2023), which learns artistic style directly from a single painting by treating style as a learnable textual description, then guiding synthesis without complex prompts. ArtAdapter Chen *et al.* [2024] introduced a multi-level style encoder with an explicit adaptation mechanism to capture both low-level textures and high-level composition.

4.3 Video Diffusion Models

Video diffusion models Ho *et al.* [2022]; Blattmann *et al.* [2023] extend image diffusion to the temporal axis. Tune-A-Video Wu *et al.* [2023] performs one-shot tuning of image diffusion for text-to-video generation. CoDeF Ouyang *et al.* [2024] and FlowVid Liang *et al.* [2024] (CVPR 2024) introduce content deformation fields and flow-guided synthesis respectively to ensure temporal coherence. The tuning-free framework ReFVFX Jones *et al.* [2026] transfers complex temporal effects from a reference video, supporting diverse artistic transformations.

5 Painting Synthesis and Stroke Rendering

Beyond pixel-level stylization, a complementary line of work models the physical creation process of paintings.

5.1 Time-Lapse and Stroke-Level Synthesis

Zhao *et al.* [2020] introduced the task of synthesizing time-lapse videos of paintings (CVPR 2020), recurrently predicting painting steps from a single completed artwork. Stylized Neural Painting Zou *et al.* [2021] (CVPR 2021) formulates image-to-painting translation as a search for physically meaningful stroke parameters through a differentiable neural renderer, producing stroke-by-stroke animations. Neural Strokes Liu *et al.* [2021] extends the idea to line drawing of 3D shapes.

5.2 Data-Driven Brushstroke Rendering

Madono and Simo-Serra [2023] proposed a data-driven ink painting brushstroke renderer trained on a robotically captured dataset of real ink paintings, faithfully reproducing complex effects such as bleeding and color mixing. Interactive video stylization via few-shot patch-based training Texler *et al.* [2020] supports user-guided stylization while preserving temporal coherence.

6 Art-Style-Specific Methods: Oil and Ink Wash Painting

6.1 Oil Painting Style Transfer

Oil painting is characterized by vivid textures, brush directionality, and rich color layers. General style transfer methods often produce blurred details and texture loss on oil paintings, motivating specialized architectures that incorporate stroke-texture constraints, adaptive content–style weighting, and color statistical alignment. Combined with diffusion backbones and painter-specific LoRAs (e.g., Van Gogh, Monet, Rembrandt), modern pipelines achieve substantially higher artistic fidelity.

6.2 Chinese Ink Wash and Shanshui Painting

Chinese ink wash painting poses unique challenges: it follows the classical five-level ink theory, employs strategic negative space, and uses brushstrokes that convey both form and spirit. Instance-Aware Coherent Video Style Transfer for Chinese Ink Wash Painting Liang *et al.* [2021] (IJCAI 2021) addresses object-level consistency in ink-wash video stylization. BiTGAN He *et al.* [2023] combines a UNet path and a ResNet path in a bilateral generator to balance structural preservation and ink texture. CVSTGAN Wang *et al.* [2024] introduces a controllable GAN for Chinese painting video style transfer. ChipDiff Liu *et al.* [2026] applies a staged diffusion model with loss-gradient guidance to better capture ink-specific aesthetics. InkSpirit Zhang *et al.* [2025] incorporates expert knowledge—blank space principles and inscription semantics—into a ComfyUI-based text-to-image framework for traditional Chinese painting.

7 Portrait and "Talking Painting" Animation

A particularly compelling application is animating famous painted portraits into "talking paintings." Zakharov *et al.* [2019] introduced few-shot adversarial learning of neural talking head models, enabling animations of the *Mona Lisa* and other portraits from a single image. LivePortrait Guo *et al.* [2024] achieves efficient portrait animation through implicit keypoints with stitching and retargeting control, generalizing to stylized portraits such as oil paintings and anime. EDTalk Tan *et al.* [2024] (ECCV 2024) disentangles mouth shape, head pose, and emotion for fine-grained control. The MEAD dataset Wang *et al.* [2020a] (ECCV 2020) provides a large-scale emotional talking-face benchmark that supports training emotion-aware animated portraits of artworks.

8 Discussion and Open Challenges

Content leakage and style–content disentanglement. Image-trained stylization often transfers semantic content from the style reference, distorting the target. Recent works Ye *et al.* [2025]; Chen *et al.* [2024] tackle this through patch filtering and auxiliary content adapters, but the problem remains open for long videos.

Long-video temporal coherence. Sliding-window strategies Li *et al.* [2026] and content deformation fields Ouyang *et al.* [2024] mitigate drift but struggle with large motion and complex scenes. Cross-turn consistency in iterative editing is a related open problem.

Art-specific aesthetic preservation. General style transfer fails to capture art-specific features such as ink density, brush direction, and compositional blank space. Specialized losses and datasets He *et al.* [2023]; Liu *et al.* [2026]; Zhang *et al.* [2025] are essential but currently limited to specific art traditions.

Integration of generation and animation pipelines. Combining painting-specific style LoRAs, ControlNet conditioning, I2V diffusion models, and talking-portrait animation into a single pipeline—as exemplified by the OilPaintingVideo project—is an emerging engineering direction with significant educational potential.

Open-source local video generation backbones. Recent open-weights video diffusion models such as LTX-Video 2.x and Wan2.1/2.2-I2V provide powerful, locally deployable backbones for famous-painting video generation. They offer controllable image-to-video synthesis with manageable GPU footprints, but are typically trained on natural imagery and struggle to preserve the rich textures and stylistic features of artworks. Bridging this domain gap—through style-aware fine-tuning, art-specific conditioning, or stroke-level guidance—remains an open and practically important problem.

Human-in-the-loop artistic guidance. Existing pipelines accept textual or image references as guidance, but professional artistic creation typically involves iterative human input through sketches, color blocks, and line drawings. Allowing artists to steer video generation with hand-drawn drafts at multiple abstraction levels—from precise line constraints to loose color palettes—is largely unexplored and offers a promising direction for human–AI co-creation.

9 Proposed Research Ideas

Building on the survey above and the open challenges identified in Section 8, we propose four research directions for famous-painting dynamic video-style generation. All four ideas share a common practical stance: they build on **open-source, locally-deployable video diffusion backbones** such as LTX-Video 2.x and Wan2.1/2.2-I2V, embed **human artistic guidance** through hand-drawn drafts (sketches, line drawings, color blocks), provide **multi-granular control** over color and stroke distributions, and introduce **art-creation-domain innovations** drawn from classical painting theory.

9.1 Idea 1: Stroke-Anchored Co-Painting Video Generation with Local Video Diffusion

Motivation. Professional painters do not think in pixels or text prompts; they think in *strokes*—their direction, pressure, color, and ordering. Current I2V pipelines accept an image and a prompt, leaving the artist outside the loop.

Core idea. Build a human-in-the-loop video generation pipeline on top of Wan2.1-I2V (or LTX-Video) where the artist provides: (i) a reference painting (e.g., a Van Gogh canvas) as the style anchor, and (ii) a sequence of *hand-drawn stroke drafts*—rough sketches and color blocks indicating where motion should occur (a swaying cypress, a flowing river). These drafts act as *spatial–temporal anchors*: a ControlNet-style adapter converts the stroke drafts into per-frame conditioning, while a

stroke-order predictor determines the temporal evolution of the color blocks.

Control granularity. The system supports both **precise** control (tight line constraints via canny/HED adapters, exact color palette matching via a histogram-conditional adapter) and **fuzzy** control (loose color-block regions, soft attention masks that allow the model to invent texture within a region).

Art-domain innovation. Inspired by the classical *fat-over-lean* principle of oil painting, we design a *stroke-temporal curriculum* that schedules the diffusion denoising steps to first establish broad color composition (lean underpainting) and then refine high-frequency brush texture (fat impasto layers). This mirrors how painters physically layer paint, and serves as a domain-informed prior that improves both temporal coherence and artistic fidelity.

Why it works. StyleMaster Ye *et al.* [2025] shows that motion adapters and patch-level style filtering substantially improve stylized video quality; combining this with stroke-level ControlNet conditioning Zhang *et al.* [2023a] and a painting-theoretic curriculum provides a principled way to inject human artistic intent into a local open-source backbone.

9.2 Idea 2: Palette-and-Line Dual-Conditioned Ink-Wash Video Synthesis

Motivation. Chinese ink wash (Shanshui) painting is governed by the classical *five-level ink theory* (焦、浓、重、淡、清) and deliberate *negative space* (留白). Existing ink-style methods He *et al.* [2023]; Liu *et al.* [2026]; Zhang *et al.* [2025] focus on single images and do not expose these art-specific axes as controllable parameters.

Core idea. Fine-tune Wan2.1-I2V with a dual-conditional adapter that accepts: (i) a *line-distribution map* (the artist's line draft of mountains, rivers, pavilions) as a structural prior, and (ii) a *color/ink-density distribution map* (hand-painted color blocks specifying the five-level ink tones and blank-space regions). The two conditions are injected at different stages of the denoising process: line distribution governs structural composition in early steps, while ink-density distribution governs tonal rendering in later steps.

Control granularity. Precise mode enforces exact ink-density histogram matching (a five-bin histogram aligned to the five ink levels) for strict aesthetic adherence; **fuzzy** mode allows the model to interpolate freely within each tonal band, producing variations suitable for creative exploration.

Art-domain innovation. We introduce a *blank-space loss* that explicitly penalizes texture generation inside user-designated negative-space regions, formalizing the aesthetic principle of *计白当黑* (treating white as black). Combined with a *rhythm-of-strokes* prior derived from calligraphic timing, the model is encouraged to produce temporally coherent "breathing" motion (drifting mist, flowing water) that respects the compositional voids—an effect difficult to achieve with generic video diffusion priors.

Why it works. ChipDiff Liu *et al.* [2026] already demonstrates that loss-gradient guidance on a diffusion model can capture ink aesthetics; extending this to a video backbone with explicit dual conditioning turns art-theoretic principles into controllable, locally-runnable tools.

9.3 Idea 3: Sketch-to-Painting-Video with Hierarchical Fuzzy-to-Precise Control

Motivation. Artists iterate: a sketch becomes a color study, then a detailed painting, then an animation. Single-shot I2V generation collapses this hierarchy into one step, denying the artist intermediate control.

Core idea. A multi-stage pipeline on LTX-Video where the user supplies a *progressive sequence of drafts*: (1) a rough sketch (line draft), (2) a color-block draft (flat regions of color), and (3) a detailed reference painting. Each draft activates a different conditional branch: sketch → structure ControlNet, color blocks → palette adapter, reference → style LoRA + IP-Adapter. The pipeline generates a short video clip at each stage, allowing the artist to refine the next draft based on the previous output—a true *fuzzy-to-precise* co-creation loop.

Control granularity. A single *control-precision knob* $\lambda \in [0, 1]$ interpolates between fuzzy guidance (low λ, the model freely interprets the drafts) and precise guidance (high λ, the output must closely match the drafts). This is implemented as a learned weighting of conditional features, giving the artist a continuous dial between creative surprise and faithful execution.

Art-domain innovation. The staged control mirrors the classical *sketch* → *underpainting* → *glazing* workflow of Western atelier practice. We further introduce a *compositional-balance loss* based on the golden ratio and rule-of-thirds, encouraging drafts and outputs to maintain classical compositional harmony—a domain prior rarely used in video generation.

Why it works. Painting Many Pasts Zhao *et al.* [2020] and Stylized Neural Painting Zou *et al.* [2021] show that stroke-by-stroke generation is feasible; our idea lifts this to the video level using a modern open-source diffusion backbone, while the fuzzy-to-precise dial addresses the controllability gap identified in StyleMaster Ye *et al.* [2025] and EchoStyle Li *et al.* [2026].

9.4 Idea 4: Living-Canvas—Collaborative Multi-Region Animation with Artist-Defined Motion Scripts

Motivation. "Talking painting" demonstrations Zakharov *et al.* [2019]; Guo *et al.* [2024] animate a single portrait. But famous paintings are often *canvases with multiple regions*—a sky, a river, a crowd, a central figure—each of which the artist may want to animate differently.

Core idea. A region-aware video generation framework built on Wan2.1-I2V (multi-region) or LTX-Video. The artist segments the reference painting into regions and assigns each a *motion script* via hand-drawn arrows, color-flow blocks, or text. Each region is conditioned independently: a sky region may receive a soft color-flow block (fuzzy control over cloud drift), while a central portrait region receives a precise line-drawing of facial motion (precise control for a "talking Mona Lisa"). A cross-region consistency module, built on CoDeF-style content deformation fields Ouyang *et al.* [2024], ensures seams between regions remain temporally coherent.

Control granularity. Per-region λ values allow mixed precision: a precise portrait next to a fuzzy impressionist background. This compositional control is not possible with monolithic I2V models.

Art-domain innovation. We introduce the concept of *focal-point choreography* from classical painting composition: the artist designates a primary focal region (high precision, strong motion) and supporting regions (low precision, ambient motion), echoing the artistic principle of *主从虚实* (primary–secondary, solid–void). The model's attention budget is biased toward focal regions, producing videos with deliberate artistic hierarchy rather than uniform motion.

Why it works. RefVFX Jones *et al.* [2026] demonstrates reference-guided temporal effect transfer, and LivePortrait Guo *et al.* [2024] shows efficient portrait animation; combining region-level conditioning with a local video diffusion backbone and focal-point choreography yields a system that respects the multi-region nature of famous paintings while keeping artists in control.

9.5 Summary of Innovations

Table 1 summarizes how each idea maps to the four requirements.

All four ideas are designed to run on a single local GPU using open-weights models, keep the artist in the loop through hand-drawn drafts at multiple abstraction levels, offer a continuous spectrum from precise to fuzzy control, and embed principles drawn from classical painting theory—together forming a coherent research agenda for famous-painting dynamic video-style generation.

Idea	Open Backbone	Human Draft	Control Granularity	Art Innovation
I1: Stroke-Anchored	Wan2.1 / LTX	Stroke drafts + color blocks	Precise & fuzzy	Fat-over-lean curriculum
I2: Palette-and-Line	Wan2.1	Line + ink-density maps	Precise & fuzzy	Five-ink theory, blank-space loss
I3: Sketch-to-Painting-Video	LTX	Sketch → color → detail	Fuzzy-to-precise dial	Atelier workflow, golden-ratio loss
I4: Living-Canvas	Wan2.1 / LTX	Per-region scripts + arrows	Per-region mixed	Focal-point choreography

Table 1: Mapping of the four proposed ideas to the design requirements.

10 Conclusion

Dynamic video-style generation for world-famous paintings is a fast-evolving intersection of artistic style transfer, diffusion-based video generation, stroke-level painting synthesis, and portrait animation. This survey has reviewed representative works across CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, AAAI, and IJCAI, organizing them along four axes, and proposed four research ideas that combine open-source local video diffusion backbones (LTX-Video, Wan2.1/2.2) with human-in-the-loop artistic guidance, multi-granular control, and art-creation-domain innovations. We believe that the convergence of pretrained diffusion backbones with art-specific knowledge, hand-drawn drafts, and temporal consistency mechanisms will continue to drive progress in this culturally significant direction, with broad applications in education, museums, and creative industries.

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